

The First Home Buyer's 90-Day Checklist — Queensland

Everything you need to sort before you sign, in plain English.

Correct as at July 2026. Grant amounts and thresholds are set by government and can change — always confirm current details with the Queensland Revenue Office (qro.qld.gov.au) before relying on this for a purchase decision. This checklist is general information, not financial or legal advice.

Section 1 — Get Your Foundations Right (Do this first, before house-hunting)

- ☐ ☐ **Check your borrowing capacity with 2-3 lenders or a mortgage broker.**
- ☐ ☐ **Check your eligibility for the First Home Owner Grant.** Currently **\$30,000** for eligible new homes valued under **\$750,000**, for contracts signed between 20 November 2023 and 30 June 2026 — after which the grant is scheduled to reduce (reported as reverting to \$15,000, with the scheme itself extended for new builds beyond that date). **Confirm the current amount directly with the QRO before relying on a specific figure**, as this is a live policy area with a scheduled change point right around your likely purchase timeline.
- ☐ ☐ **Understand the transfer duty (stamp duty) concessions — these are separate from the FHOG and often the bigger saving.** As of 1 May 2025: **new homes and vacant land** purchased by eligible first home buyers attract **zero transfer duty, with no price cap**. For **established homes**, a full exemption applies up to **\$700,000**, with a sliding-scale concession up to **\$800,000**.
- ☐ ☐ **Know the residency requirement.** You must move in within 1 year of settlement and live there continuously for at least 1 year to keep these concessions — you cannot rent the property out during this period.
- ☐ ☐ **Note the June 2026 eligibility update.** Following the Queensland State Budget, eligibility for these transfer duty concessions is being limited to Australian citizens, permanent residents, and specified foreign retirees, applying to transactions from 1 August 2026 — check your eligibility status if this applies to you.
- ☐ ☐ **Check if you qualify for the federal First Home Guarantee** (5% deposit, no LMI) — confirm current price caps for your target area with a participating lender.
- ☐ ☐ **Get formal pre-approval, not just an estimate**, to confirm your real, lender-verified budget.

Section 2 — While You're Searching

- ☐ ☐ **Set a firm maximum price** based on your pre-approval.
- ☐ ☐ **Budget for costs beyond the purchase price:** conveyancing fees, building and pest inspections (genuinely critical in Queensland's climate — see Section 3), loan fees, and moving costs.
- ☐ ☐ **In Queensland's tropical/subtropical regions, check for climate-specific risks** — flood risk and elevation, cyclone exposure, and general water damage/mould/termite susceptibility, which are more common concerns here than in southern states.

Section 3 — Know Your Legal Protections Before You Sign

- ☐ ☐ **Understand the cooling-off period.** You generally get **5 business days** from the date of contract to withdraw on a private treaty sale. If you withdraw during this period, you forfeit **0.25% of the purchase price** to the seller. There is **no cooling-off period at auction**.
- ☐ ☐ **Know about Queensland's new Seller Disclosure Statement regime — a major change you should understand.** Since **1 August 2025**, sellers of freehold property in Queensland must give buyers a **Seller Disclosure Statement (Form 2)** and prescribed certificates **before you sign the contract**. This is a fundamental shift from Queensland's historical "buyer beware" approach.
- ☐ ☐ **Know your rights if disclosure is missing or wrong.** If you don't receive a valid disclosure statement, or it's materially inaccurate or incomplete, you can **terminate the contract at any time before settlement** and are entitled to a **full refund of your deposit, plus any accrued interest**.
- ☐ ☐ **Get a building and pest inspection done before your cooling-off period ends (private treaty) or before auction day.** There's no cooling-off period at auction, so this is essential before bidding.

Section 4 — Between Signing and Settlement

- ☐ ☐ **Confirm building insurance timing with your solicitor/conveyancer.**
- ☐ ☐ **Finalise unconditional loan approval** well before settlement.
- ☐ ☐ **Book a pre-settlement inspection** in the days before settlement.
- ☐ ☐ **Confirm who's lodging your FHOG and transfer duty concession paperwork** — typically your solicitor/conveyancer via Form D2.1, but confirm this explicitly.

Section 5 — Common First-Home-Buyer Mistakes to Avoid

- ☐ ☐ **Don't assume the FHOG applies to established homes** — it's new homes only; the transfer duty concessions are what apply to established homes.
- ☐ ☐ **Don't skip the inspection** — Queensland's climate makes termite and water-damage issues a genuine, common risk, not a rare edge case.
- ☐ ☐ **Don't assume old grant/duty figures still apply** — this is a genuinely fast-moving policy area in Queensland right now (grant amount changing mid-2026, eligibility rules changing August 2026), so confirm current settings close to your actual purchase date.
- ☐ ☐ **Don't rent the property out within your first year** if you've claimed FHOG or duty concessions — this breaches the residency requirement.

Quick Reference — Queensland First Home Buyer Support (July 2026)

SUPPORT	AMOUNT / DETAIL	APPLIES TO
First Home Owner Grant	\$30,000 (until 30 June 2026, then reducing — confirm current	New homes ≤\$750,000

First Home Owner Grant	figure)	New homes, ≤\$750,000
Transfer duty exemption (new home/vacant land)	\$0 duty, no price cap	Since 1 May 2025
Transfer duty exemption (established home)	\$0 duty	≤\$700,000
Transfer duty concession (established home)	Sliding scale	\$700,000–\$800,000
Cooling-off period	5 business days	Private treaty only, not auctions — 0.25% penalty to withdraw
Seller Disclosure Statement	Mandatory before you sign	Since 1 August 2025

Sources: Queensland Revenue Office (qro.qld.gov.au), Queensland Government. Always verify current figures before making a purchase decision — grant amounts and eligibility are changing through mid-to-late 2026.

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